DIANA SIMONDS

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EDUCATION

Duke University; M.A., Digital Art History & Computational Media *2025 – Expected Dec. 2026*

Claremont McKenna College; B.A., Philosophy & Film (Dual Degree, Honors) *2020 – 2024*

– Honors senior thesis: “Para Ser Cambiado, Ser El Cambio.”

WORK EXPERIENCE

Founder’s Associate *Aug. 2026 – Oct. 2026*

The Art Plug, Miami, FL

– Supported artist and founder Marcel Katz across creative projects, partnerships, and business initiatives; managed partner communications, scheduling, and presentation decks.

– Produced organic content and coordinated partnerships and event preparations for Miami Art Week.

Founder & Art Advisor *Jun. 2026 – Present*

Diana Simonds Art Advisory, Miami, FL

– Guide clients in defining their aesthetic, sourcing artwork, and building personalized collections; present acquisition recommendations and negotiate pricing.

– Coordinate shipping, framing, international imports, and installation, balancing design vision with long-term collection value.

Creative Direction & Social Media Lead *Jan. 2026 – Present*

Muse System Enterprises, Miami, FL

– Lead creative direction and design across the full product portfolio; build and execute social media, branding, and marketing strategy.

– Direct screenwriting, animation, and brand marketing for the flagship *UglyDolls* YouTube series.

– Test and refine products using client and user feedback; collaborate with external partners and development teams on enhancements.

Teaching Assistant & Research Assistant *Dec. 2025 – May 2026*

Duke University, Durham, NC

– **Teaching:** developed lesson plans with professors, led three class sessions on emerging technology and ethics, and coached students on projects and essays.

– **Research:** with Dr. Paul Jaskot, studied forced labor in Nazi-occupied Krakow; collected and analyzed 300+ video testimonies in under six weeks.

Exhibition & Communications Manager *Jan. 2024 – Jun. 2025*

International Arts & Artists, Washington, DC

– Promoted from intern to manager in under six months; became Exhibition Project Manager, owning exhibitions from concept through tour as primary contact for curators.

– Grew social following from 10K to 50K+ in one year, managing paid campaigns across Instagram, Facebook, and Google; launched marketing for the BFF pop-up exhibition.

– Authored an 80-page annual board report, supported board meeting graphic design, and coordinated trustee onboarding.

– Organized NATO symposium logistics and social outreach; contributed to grant applications and led hiring and onboarding of new staff.

Lead Student Research Analyst *Aug. 2022 – May 2024*

The Gould Center, Claremont, CA

– Analyzed race, spirituality, and hip-hop for Dr. Gaston Espinosa; delivered weekly summaries and presentations to center faculty.

– Led a weekly Instagram livestream series and organized a day-long symposium with Ukrainian professors and students.

HONORS & EXTRACURRICULARS

– Short film selected for the “Clean Air Day” Film Festival.

– DAHVC Research Lab, *Mapping Occupied Krakow* (Jan. – May 2026): digitally mapped architectural labor at Nazi concentration camps; archived SHOAH Foundation testimonials.

– ASCMC Club Liaison (2020): point of contact between CMC clubs and student government; organized events and budgets.

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

– **Languages:** English (native), Spanish (advanced), Portuguese (conversational), Italian (beginner).

– **Creative:** advanced graphic design, video production, and camera operation across the Adobe and Google suites.